The Bureau of Meteorology

IDS11074
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia Gulf Waters

Issued at 3:30 pm CDT on Tuesday 20 October 2026
for the period until midnight CDT Friday 23 October 2026.

Please be aware
Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A trough of low pressure lingers about the east, before weakening from late Wednesday. A slow moving high pressure system in the Tasman Sea will re-establish a ridge across southern parts from Wednesday. A trough is then forecast to briefly move into the west on Thursday, before another trough and cold front move more broadly across SA on Friday and Saturday.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots north of Cowell to Wallaroo during the afternoon and evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres north of Cowell to Wallaroo by early evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to around 1 metre south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southwesterly in the middle of the day then tending south to southeasterly in the evening. Winds reaching up to 20 knots north of Cowell to Wallaroo in the late afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo during the afternoon. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Northwest to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending southerly during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

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Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southwesterly in the middle of the day then tending south to southeasterly in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming northwest to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the morning then tending southerly during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

Central Coast

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots tending southeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: East to southeasterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots turning north to northeasterly below 10 knots before dawn then becoming variable in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres in the west. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming southerly 10 to 15 knots during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southeasterly in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable about 10 knots in the middle of the day then becoming southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday, then increasing to 1 to 2 metres later in the evening. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming northwest to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the morning then tending south to southeasterly during the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 pm CDT Tuesday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.

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